

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2
PAPER 2 November 2020

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2020 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

Nyamhuka clinic

Sister Nyasha had learned to hear the difference between wind and a motorbike on the dirt road. The clinic at Nyamhuka was a low building with a veranda that peeled like sunburnt skin. On this afternoon the sky bruised quickly, and the first drops raised the smell of hot dust. A woman arrived carrying a child whose breathing sounded like paper being crumpled. “How long?” Sister Nyasha asked, already reaching for the stethoscope that had been mended with tape. “Since morning. We waited for a lift.”

The generator had failed at noon. A nurse-aide held a phone torch while Sister Nyasha worked. She spoke to the child as if he were a colleague, because fear made small lungs tighter. Outside, thunder walked across the hills. A file of patients under the veranda did not leave; they had walked too far to surrender their place in the queue.

When the child’s chest eased, the mother wept without noise, the way people weep when they have practised not being a burden. Sister Nyasha wrote a referral she was not sure they could afford, then crossed it out and wrote another that used the mission hospital’s charity desk. She hated the arithmetic of kindness, but she had become fluent in it.

Lightning whitened the yard. The motorbike she had been expecting belonged to Mr Gumbo, who delivered drugs when the district truck was “coming next week,” a phrase that had lost its meaning. He arrived soaked, laughing, a crate of saline on his lap as if it were a baby. “The road is a river,” he said, “but rivers can be argued with.” Sister Nyasha took the crate, and for the first time that day her hands were not entirely steady. She was not a hero in her own mind. She was a woman who had missed her son’s football match again, and who would miss the next one, and who would still unlock the clinic before the birds.

2. (a) What two problems face the clinic in this extract? [2]
(b) Why have the patients on the veranda not gone home when the storm starts? [2]
(c) In your own words, explain “the arithmetic of kindness”. [4]
(d) What do we learn about Mr Gumbo’s character from his arrival? [4]
(e) How does the last paragraph prevent Sister Nyasha from seeming unrealistically heroic? [4]
(f) What does “waited for a lift” tell us about the family’s situation? [4] **[20]**
3. Summarise, in not more than 160 words, Sister Nyasha’s actions and feelings during the afternoon. Continuous prose. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. You answer a landline in an office. The proper opening is: **[2]**

- A) Good morning, Mutasa High School, may I help you?
- B) Yes?
- C) Who is this?
- D) Talk, I'm listening.

5. You are late for a lesson. When you enter, you should say: **[2]**

- A) The other class is also late.
- B) It's not my fault, the bell is wrong.
- C) What did I miss?
- D) May I come in, Sir/Madam? I am sorry I am late.

6. On WhatsApp, your aunt asks you to greet your mother. You reply: **[2]**

- A) Tell her yourself lol.
- B) I will pass on your greetings, Aunt. Thank you.
- C) K
- D) Mom is annoying today.

7. A classmate borrows your pen and does not return it. You say: **[2]**

- A) May I have my pen back, please? I need it for the next lesson.
- B) I'm telling the whole school.
- C) Buy your own, beggar.
- D) You always steal.

8. A librarian asks you to lower your voice. You say: **[2]**

- A) Make me.
- B) Other people are louder.
- C) This is a free country.
- D) Sorry, I'll be quieter.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).